BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #72 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

“I'm useless to the church now.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When we cannot attend, teach, serve, or give as before, we may feel invisible to the church. Sometimes churches fail to include those who are limited.

What Scripture teaches

“The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable.” “Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good.” “Carry one another’s burdens.” Those who are ill can pray, encourage, give wisdom, and remind a congregation that the body includes the weak. The church also has a duty to care for the sick: “I was sick and you looked after Me.” You have a place, and the church should make room.

> *“On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable”* (1 Corinthians 12:22).

Also see

> “Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good” (1 Corinthians 12:7).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “I was naked and you clothed Me, I was sick and you looked after Me, I was in prison and you visited Me.’” (Matthew 25:36).

> “From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part” (Ephesians 4:16).

Common self-statements

- The church does not need me.
- I contribute nothing.
- They have forgotten me.
- I am a burden to the church.
- I used to be useful.
- Only active people matter.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either active or useless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that the church will forget me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling sidelined and concluding I am useless.
- Labeling: Calling myself useless.

Challenging questions

- What roles can I still do, such as prayer, calls, and notes?
- Whom could I encourage?
- Have I told my church how I can participate?

- What does Scripture say about weaker members?
- What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- Who in church could help me stay connected?

Truth summary

> The body of Christ needs its weaker members. I can pray, encourage, and share my story. I can tell my church what I need and what I can give.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Church
- Friendship
- Weakness
- Loneliness
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm useless to the church now"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm useless to the church now." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What roles can I still do, such as prayer, calls, and notes?
- ☐ Whom could I encourage?
- ☐ Have I told my church how I can participate?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about weaker members?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- ☐ Who in church could help me stay connected?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ I have a gift for the common good.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ The church should visit the sick.
- ☐ I can pray and encourage.
- ☐ I am part of the body.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:7
  "Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Still part of the body: Each week, note one contribution to the church.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 12:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Weaker parts of the body are indispensable.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Church" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Tell the pastor. Share your limits and what you can offer.
- ☐ Pray for the church. Choose a ministry to pray for.
- ☐ Write notes. Encourage others.
- ☐ Ask for visits. Let the church love you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm useless to the church now": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still part of the body
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm useless to the church now.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel useless to Your church. Show me my place, and help the church embrace weaker members like me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.